Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, October 19, 2020 at 6:30 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier gave a short introduction regarding the electronic Council meeting format and noted that the meeting was being live streamed on the Town's website.

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 6:30 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Closed Session (6:32 p.m.)

Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (k) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss a position, plan, procedure, criteria or instruction to be applied to any negotiations carried on or to be carried on by or on behalf of the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

3.1 Confidential Negotiations

Open Meeting (7:02 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In Closed Session

Ratify Directions from Closed Session

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That all directions approved in the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

4. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following Minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of September 21, 2020;
- Closed Session Meeting of September 21, 2020;
- Special Meeting of September 28, 2020;
- Closed session Meeting of September 28, 2020; and
- Special Meeting of October 5, 2020

CARRIED

5. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. No questions were received.

6. Delegation and Petitions/Public Hearings

With the consent of Council Members, item 6.2 was brought forward in the order of business.

6.2 Vision Zero Update

Steven Kemp, Manager – Traffic Engineering and Operations, Regional Municipality of Durham and Amanda Spencer, Program Manager – Road Safety, Regional Municipality of Durham, presented information on the Vision Zero program to eliminate fatal and injury collisions in Durham Region. S. Kemp outlined the pillars of the program, and the vision and goal to achieve a 10% reduction in fatal and injury collisions over a five-year period.

A. Spencer reviewed eight areas monitored as part of the program, including intersections, aggressive driving, distracted driving, young drivers, pedestrians, impaired driving, cyclists, and commercial vehicles. She reviewed five-year total fatal and injury collisions by focus area on regional and local municipal roads and identified actions implemented to mitigate fatal and injury collisions.

S. Kemp reviewed Ajax-specific mapping and collision data for 2014 to 2018 and

highlighted projects including traffic signal installation, automated speed enforcement (ASE) and Red Light Camera activations.

Members of Council asked questions regarding distracted driving when at a stop light, age demographics for distracted drivers, educational/awareness campaigns, motor vehicle collision fatality rate in Ajax, the impact of COVID-19 on traffic volumes, and location of ASE installations. S. Kemp and A. Spencer responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked S. Kemp and A. Spencer for their presentation.

6.1 **Durham Regional Police Service – West Division Update**

Inspector Mitch Martin and Staff Sergeant Mike Brown of Durham Regional Police West Division, provided an overview of crime trends and statistics. Decreases in violent offences, property offences, and residential break and enters were noted, while business break and enters and motor vehicle thefts have increased since this time last year. Inspector Martin discussed roadway safety, motor vehicle collisions, impaired collisions, call types and response, as well as shootings and discharge of fire arms. Staff Sgt. Brown shared information on a recent “Lock it or Lose it” campaign in South Ajax, and discussed traffic ticket issuance and blitzes.

Members of Council asked questions regarding policing plans for the Durham Live development site, the number of shooting incidents in Ajax, DRPS actions to address systemic racism, communications, and crack down on modified motor vehicles.

Inspector Martin and Staff Sgt. Brown responded to questions from Council and shared information on the diversity of West Division and initiatives undertaken to engage with diverse populations, including a Sunday Virtual Call session. The presenters discussed efforts to crack down on incidents involving modified vehicles, as well as an increase in shooting and discharge incidents in Ajax and Pickering over this time last year.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Inspector Martin and Staff Sgt. Brown for their update.

6.3 **Durham Region Transit Service Re-design and Transit system Enhancements**

Christopher Norris, Deputy General Manager, Operations, Durham Region Transit, delivered a presentation on the Durham Region Transit Ridership Recovery Strategy. He discussed a decrease in current ridership due to COVID-19 and shared information on a multi-phase service plan to align services strategically with changing customer demand. C. Norris provided an overview of Phase A of the service plan, which includes on-demand service and expansion of transit in rural areas. C. Norris discussed Durham Region Transit’s new Trip planning, On-Demand and e-ticketing applications, integrated customer experience, contactless fare payment options, and provided a summary of communication and promotion of service changes.

Council Members asked questions regarding demographics of ridership, impact on the student population, clarification of how the on-demand service functions, COVID-19 safety protocols for on-demand service, and possible integration of online platforms into a single DRT application. C. Norris responded to questions from Members of Council.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked C. Norris for his presentation.

7. Correspondence

Councillor Khan shared information on the origins of Islamic History Month, in relation to Item 1 of the correspondence report.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report dated October 19, 2020 containing Items of Correspondence be adopted.

CARRIED

8. Reports

8.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated October 5, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

8.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the General Government Committee Report dated October 13, 2020, be adopted.

CARRIED

8.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated October 19, 2020, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

8.4 Departmental Reports

8.4.1 Traffic Calming Along Williamson Drive West Petition

Members of Council asked questions regarding the data collected to update the

Traffic Calming Warrant, and the potential to evaluate the area for the creation of a community safety zone at a later date. John Grieve, Transportation Supervisor, responded to questions from Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the report entitled "Traffic Calming along Williamson Drive West Petition" be received for information.

CARRIED

8.4.2 **Safe Restart Funding - Phase 2 Application**

Members of Council asked questions regarding potential for additional phases of funding. D. Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer and K. Cruciano, Grants & Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, responded to questions from Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Council direct staff to apply for the second phase of federal-provincial safe Restart Funding by the October 30, 2020 deadline.

CARRIED

9. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillors provided an update regarding Durham Regional Council matters, including pandemic response for people experiencing homelessness including a 50 micro-home design project to be located in Beverton, a presentation from the Interim Chief Rollauer of Durham Regional Police Services, a presentation on the regional consolidated budget status report, and a presentation on the creation of a regional diversity, equity and inclusion division.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Report of October 19, 2020 be received for information.

CARRIED

10. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

10.1 **Economic Development Roundtable**

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Regional Councillor Crawford and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Regional Councillor Crawford responded to questions on the motion from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS Ajax Council has a strong, clear mandate and focus on economic development as a priority for the 2018-2022 term; and

WHEREAS Town of Ajax (TOR) BIAs are localized to specific, strategic locations including downtown and Pickering Village, but they do not encompass large employment areas within the Town, like the Carruthers Creek Business Area, Salem Business Area, the Central Employment Area, and the Audley Road Business Area; and

WHEREAS Ajax Council wants to be more proactive in building and maintaining open lines of communication between business and industry leaders, and Council and TOA staff to guide processes, policies and procedures to reduce red tape and support business growth and retention; and

WHEREAS the Town's Economic Development department is currently working on finalizing a new 5-year Economic Development Plan to emphasize job creation through new investments and business expansion in line with the vision of Council; and

WHEREAS the COVID-19 pandemic has caused major disruptions to businesses, mostly small and medium-sized operations that make up a significant amount of our employers in the town; and

WHEREAS Economic Development Roundtables are commonplace across GTA municipalities and beyond, to provide additional opportunities to connect directly with the business community, and serve to complement, bring together and build on work done by BIAs, Economic Development teams and Boards of Trade/Chambers of Commerce;

THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

1. That Ajax Council directs staff to engage in a series of Economic Development Roundtables (EDRs) as part of the new Economic Development Plan; and

2. That the EDRs be managed and supported by Economic Development staff; and

3. That Economic Development staff work with the Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator to proactively recruit for and promote the EDRs throughout fall 2020, targeting residents, business and industry leaders in Ajax, to support an inaugural event in January 2021; and

4. That the EDR event series be held quarterly to advise staff on actions outlined in the Economic Development Plan, and discuss matters of importance to local business success, including (but not limited to) trends, challenges, growth opportunities and job creation in a manner conducive to open dialogue, honest insights and strategy development; and

5. That Ajax Council receive regular updates on the EDR series from Economic Development staff, providing key observations, recommendations and outcomes regarding local business matters.

CARRIED

<u>Recorded Vote</u>

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Bower, Councillor Khan, Regional Councilor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Dies

Opposed: None

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10.2 **Traffic Signal and Crosswalk at Fishlock St. and Harwood Ave. N**

Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents, and responded to questions on the motion from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS the T intersection at Fishlock St. and Harwood Ave. N was last studied in 2014, and at that time was not warranted for signalization; and

WHEREAS there has been tremendous growth in the area and along Harwood; making it difficult for pedestrians and drivers to maneuver through the intersection, resulting in confusion and most recently a motor vehicle accident;

THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

1. That staff be directed to review the Fishlock/Harwood intersection using available pedestrian crossing and traffic signal warrants; and

2. That staff report back to Council with the results of the review.

CARRIED

10.3 **Council 2021 Remuneration Freeze**

Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS the COVID-19 pandemic continues to negatively affect the economic livelihood of Ajax residents, now and into the foreseeable future;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council wishes to support Ajacians throughout this crisis by continuing to provide critical municipal services to the community with minimal increases to costs;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council members' remuneration is reviewed and adjusted annually to reflect the average council compensation of the other Durham Region lakeshore municipalities;

AND WHEREAS the last review of Ajax Council members' remuneration was completed in March of 2020, prior to the emergency declarations by the Province of Ontario and the municipality;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

THAT staff be directed to freeze Council members' salary, travel allowance, and benefits for 2021 at the approved 2020 rates;

AND THAT staff be directed to continue to conduct the annual review of council member remuneration for 2021, with the condition that salary, travel allowance, and all other benefits comprising council's total remuneration shall not be recommended to increase for 2021 based on the outcome of the review, but may be recommended to decrease should the review identify a decline in the average remuneration across the lakeshore municipalities of Durham Region.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10.4 **Traffic Calming Action for Williamson Drive**
(deferred from July 27, 2020 Special Council Meeting)

Councillor Khan introduced the motion and reviewed its contents and responded to questions from Council Members regarding evaluation of the location under the updated traffic warrant. John Grieve, Transportation Supervisor, provided information regarding results of the 2020 Traffic Warrant evaluation, noting the location did not meet the requirements.

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

WHEREAS Town staff completed a traffic calming analysis of Williamson Drive West between Bellinger and Westney in the Fall of 2018 and the results showed that the road segment was not eligible for traffic calming at that time;

AND WHEREAS members of Council and Town staff have received numerous complaints from residents regarding serious traffic issues on Williamson Drive West over the past two years;

AND WHEREAS there was a recent fatal motor vehicle accident at Westney Road and Williamson Drive, and residents continue to call for traffic calming action;

NOW THEREFORE IT BE RESOLVED that Council direct staff to prepare a preliminary design and cost estimate for the installation of two asphalt speed humps on Williamson Drive West between Bellinger and Westney Road;

AND THAT staff be directed to report back to Council at the September GGC with a preliminary design and cost estimate associated with the above installation of the traffic calming measure on Williamson Drive West.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee

Opposed: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

MOTION LOST

11. By-laws

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 40-2020 to 41-2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

12. Notice of Motion

None

13. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities, including Pumpkinville, local restaurant BINGO, and virtual ward meetings and live with the Mayor session. Council Members extended congratulations to Community Development Council Durham on its 50th Anniversary.

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 42-2020 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on October 19, 2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the October 19, 2020 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (9:55 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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Acting D-Clerk